



ATTACHMENT IS THE ROOT OF SUFFERING

**SIDDHARTHA GAUTAMA
PREACHES BUDDHISM (c. 500 BCE)**

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

The spread of Buddhism

BEFORE

1200 BCE Vedic (aka Aryan) culture extends across northern and central India.

1200–800 BCE Oral Vedic traditions are written down in Sanskrit as the Vedas.

c. 600 BCE The Mahajanapadas, the 16 competing kingdoms of Vedic India, emerge.

AFTER

322 BCE Chandragupta Maurya founds the Mauryan Empire.

3rd century BCE Sri Lanka converts to Buddhism.

185 BCE The Mauryan Empire collapses.

1st century CE Buddhism arrives in China and Japan.

7th century Buddhist missionaries are invited to establish a monastery in Tibet.

Siddhartha Gautama, better known as the Buddha, was born at the end of the Vedic Age (1800–600 BCE) into a South Asia in transition. In the country's caste system, the priestly Brahmins and the warrior-elite Kshatriyas ranked highest,

Siddhartha rejects material life and preaches Buddhist philosophy.

Ashoka the Great conquers India and unifies the empire.

Ashoka **makes Buddhism the state religion** and spreads it across South and East Asia.

After the collapse of the Mauryan Empire, **Buddhism declines in India.**

Buddhism flourishes in Sri Lanka, Southeast Asia, China, Japan, Tibet, and Central Asia.

and it was into this latter group that Siddhartha Gautama was born.

India was then a ferment of sects and new ideologies, some of which espoused a philosophy renouncing the material world. Siddhartha developed a similar philosophy based on mystical Hinduism, but he also rejected the increasingly rigid strictures of Vedic ritual and the inherited piety of the Brahmins. Renouncing material possessions, he sought and eventually found enlightenment, and became the